JOSH HINKLE

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PROFILE

Engineering leader running SoFi's Fraud & Anti-Money Laundering (AML) engineering org: 25 people across fraud, AML, and data engineering teams. Owns the real-time risk decisioning platform that protects 14M+ members across SoFi's suite of consumer and business financial products.

7 years at SoFi through hypergrowth: pre-IPO to IPO and a national bank charter, and from 1M members to 14M+. Promoted from Software Engineer to Senior Staff before moving into management.

Technologies: Java, Kotlin, Python, SQL, AWS, Kubernetes, Kafka, Snowflake, Spring Boot, machine learning infrastructure

PROFESSIONAL EXPERIENCE

SOFI

March 2019 - Present

Senior Manager, Software Engineering

January 2025 - Present

- Lead SoFi's Fraud & AML engineering org of 25 across three teams (Fraud Engineering, Fraud & AML Data Engineering, and AML Engineering), with engineers in US and European time zones. 16 direct reports, including the engineering manager who leads AML Engineering.
- Led fraud and AML engineering for all 8 of the CEO's company priorities in the past year, including net-new products like crypto withdrawals, SoFi Pay, and business banking, where fraud controls were built from scratch. Launched crypto withdrawals to 493K members with fraud losses 80% below the limit set for launch.
- Created a new model for how fraud engineering supports launches: one fraud engineer embeds with the product team as a forward-deployed engineer, and the product team writes and owns the integration code. It's now the default for new launches and has tripled the number of concurrent initiatives fraud engineering can support.
- Hired engineers across IC levels, promoted engineers to Senior, Staff, and Senior Staff, and handled coaching and performance management. Developed a Staff engineer into a manager.
- Raised outbound instant-payment volume 23% and cut blocked transfers 89% by replacing fixed transfer caps with risk-based decisions, tested on 2.1M members with no rise in fraud losses.
- Rebuilt transfer limits and fraud controls across 5 payment rails for SoFi's core banking migration. Members now get same-day access to 42% of the money they move in from other banks, up from 15%.
- Own SoFi's fraud and AML decisioning platform, returning real-time decisions in under 20ms p95 for banking, lending, and investing products. Built the fraud data lakehouse its models and rules are trained and tested on (260M+ transactions, 28K labeled fraud cases).
- Consolidated new and legacy AML pipelines onto the risk platform. Payment products now get fraud and AML controls through one integration, and SoFi's first in-house AML risk model scores 11.5M customers a month in place of a vendor model.

Senior Staff Software Engineer

September 2024 - January 2025

Staff Software Engineer *September 2022 - August 2024*
Senior Software Engineer *September 2020 - August 2022*
Software Engineer *March 2019 - August 2020*

- Tech lead for SoFi's 2nd-generation financial services platform; architected the product-agnostic onboarding platform behind member onboarding across SoFi products.
- Authored the FRN (Financial Resource Name) spec, a URN-style identifier standard used across SoFi's 100+ microservices for resource identification and authorization.
- Tech lead for Samsung Money by SoFi; designed the partner webhooks API (100M+ messages, zero dropped) and the org-wide data pipeline on Kinesis, S3, and Snowflake.

OTC EXCHANGE NETWORK ("OTCXN") | Software Engineer

June - December 2018

NASA AMES RESEARCH CENTER | Software Engineer (Contract), previously Intern

January 2017 - May 2018

EDUCATION

San Jose State University | B.S. Chemical Engineering, Minor in Computer Science